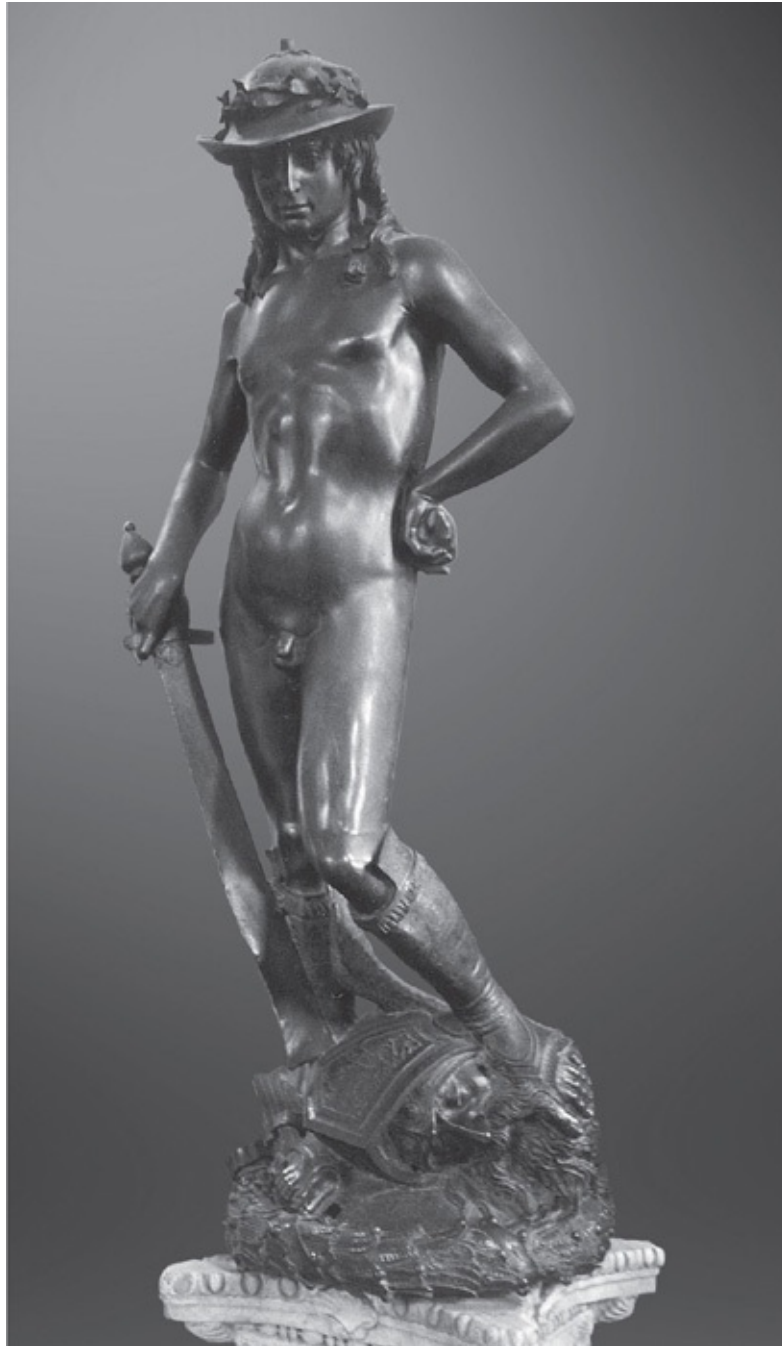


Masaccio and Donatello

One of the most revolutionary painters of the Early Renaissance, Tommaso di Ser Giovanni di Simone (1401–28), created a convincing sense of three-dimensionality. Better known as Masaccio (a nickname meaning clumsy or messy Tom) he was one of the first painters to use linear perspective. He discarded the ornamentation of the International Gothic and followed Giotto's method of using light and tone to create a sense of depth and solidity. Combined with his use of linear perspective, his works appeared astonishingly lifelike to contemporaries.

Masaccio was influenced by his friend Donatello, or Donato di Niccolò di Betto Bardi (c.1386–1466), who created statues and reliefs in marble, bronze and wood. Donatello learned his craft in the workshop of Lorenzo Ghiberti, the most important bronze sculptor of the time. A unique approach diffused his figures with emotion and dignity that echoed Greek Classicism. His bronze statue of David (c.1440s) was the first free-standing nude male sculpture created since antiquity. Shockingly, he was naked.



Donatello, *David*, c.1440s